

INTEROFFICE COMMUNICATION
San Mateo Police Department
Support Services Division

DATE: October 20, 2021

TO: Captain David Peruzzaro

FROM: Lieutenant Todd Mefford

RE: Summary of Quarterly Audit of SMPD 'End-User' ALPR Data for Q3, 2021

Introduction

Per SMPD Standard Operating Procedure 205, our Department conducts quarterly audits of our 'End-User' data to ensure our employees are reviewing data in a manner consistent with policy and procedure. The data reviewed is generated and provided by the Northern California Regional Intelligence Center (NCRIC) and the Flock Platform Portal as they house data for the respective platforms. The results of these audits are summarized and presented to the Support Services Captain for review and later for retention by the Support Services Division.

Quarter 2, 2021

PIPs / BOSS (April, May & June)

ALPR Committee met and determined that the PIPs/BOSS ALPR platform and hardware equipment was antiquated causing a significant drain on resources. Additionally, the platform was often not performing correctly and had significant downtime due to connectivity and computer issues. The ALPR Committee agreed that we would terminate the contract with Neology, Inc., the parent company of PIPs/BOSS. On 5/25/21 official notification was sent to Neology via certified mail cancelling their services. We continue to have access to BOSS for queries, but we are no longer contributing to the database through our PIPs cameras. PIPs system cameras captured 263,227 reads this quarter.

Audit Focus	Q2/2021	Quarterly Average
Number of searches	82	62
Number of searches with required criteria (as %)	100%	99.8%
Case numbers listed	71	70
Non-case numbers listed	11	10
(Reasons for search)		
Missing/Amber/Silver Alert	0	1
Criminal or Arrest	36	30
Special Event	0	0
Stolen or Wanted	46	39
Violent Crime	Unk	7

Quarter 2, 2021

Flock Safety April, May & June)

This is the first complete audit of the Flock data since going online in February 2021. This audit will include a full sampling of the entire 3 months of data. After the first Flock audit, training was determined necessary for staff to enter the appropriate reason for search. We implemented training in the form of a procedure update memo and as a result 100% of the reason for query was entered in Q2. This marked an 85% improvement in the entry of required reason for search. There has been an overall 64% increase in the department's usage of the Flock ALPR platform. The "Number of Searches" indicates searches of a license plate against a particular database; for instance, when an officer queries a plate, it searches NCIC, SVS, and other municipalities where we have access to their ALPR data. Single plate query appears as numerous searches because it is searching the individual databases, hence the high "Number of Searches."

Audit Focus	Q2/2021	Quarterly Average
Number of searches	5,951	4,510
Number of searches with required criteria (as %)	100%	98.5%
Case numbers listed	5,255	3,667
Non-case numbers listed	696	828

Analysis and Conclusion

Our department 'End-User' activity during the time period was consistent with Department policy and procedure. Our staff used this technology platform above normal usage rates, which is reasonable given the types of investigations they were conducting. No additional efforts are recommended.